Valgrind is an application for detecting C-based memory leaks and race conditions.

There are Valgrind tools that can automatically detect many memory management and threading bugs, and profile your programs in detail. For example, if a C extension in the interpreter calls malloc() but doesn't properly call free(), this memory won't be available until the app terminates.

For further information on how to install Valgrind and use with Ruby, refer to Valgrind and Ruby by Evan Weaver.

6 Plugins for Debugging

There are some Rails plugins to help you to find errors and debug your application. Here is a list of useful plugins for debugging:

Footnotes Every Rails page has footnotes that give request information and link back to your source via TextMate.
Query Trace Adds query origin tracing to your logs.
Query Reviewer This Rails plugin not only runs "EXPLAIN" before each of your select queries in development, but provides a small DIV in the rendered output of each page with the summary of warnings for each query that it analyzed.

Exception Notifier Provides a mailer object and a default set of templates for sending email notifications when errors occur in a Rails application.
Better Errors Replaces the standard Rails error page with a new one containing more contextual information, like source code and variable inspection.

RailsPanel Chrome extension for Rails development that will end your tailing of development.log. Have all information about your Rails app requests in the browser — in the Developer Tools panel. Provides insight to db/rendering/ total times, parameter list, rendered views and more.
Pry An IRB alternative and runtime developer console.